

OFFICIAL SPEECH TRANSCRIPT — SPEECH 3
CYBER SECURITY & DIGITAL PRIVACY

AGENDA ITEM

Cyber Security & Digital Privacy

Honorable Chair, Distinguished Delegates,

The delegation of Croatia wishes to draw the Council's attention to a modern threat that is often invisible but highly dangerous: cyber warfare.

Today, Russia's cyber operations do not only target military networks. They actively target humanitarian databases containing the sensitive personal information of millions of Ukrainian refugees.

For Croatia, protecting civilians means protecting them both in the physical world and the digital world. If a refugee's digital identity or location data is stolen by malicious actors, their physical safety and the safety of their families back home are put in great danger.

To address the fifth question of our study guide, Croatia proposes two main actions:

First, NATO's cyber defense experts must cooperate directly with humanitarian agencies to build stronger firewalls and secure registration databases for displaced persons.

Second, we must support Ukraine in protecting its critical digital infrastructure, ensuring that online communication lines and essential banking services remain active and safe for civilians.

We cannot protect people's lives if we fail to protect their data.

Thank you, and I yield my time back to the Chair.

Delegation of Croatia
North Atlantic Council Session